

AIR.MUSIC

ARTIST RESOURCE GUIDE

FOR INDEPENDENT OPM ARTISTS

AI MUSIC & STREAMING PLATFORMS

What actually works, what gets blocked, and your real paths forward as an independent artist.

AIR.IO
PHILIPPINES

GOOD MUSIC TAKES TIME
Keep building. We'll be here.

INTRODUCTION

WHY YOU'RE READING THIS

You applied to AIR Music, and we had to pause your application — not because your music isn't interesting, but because of how it was made.

Fully AI-generated tracks without the right licensing create real problems on streaming platforms. Not just for us — for you. This guide exists so you understand exactly what's happening, and what your actual options are.

WHAT PLATFORMS ACTUALLY CHECK

Spotify, Apple Music, YouTube Music and most major platforms now have two layers of detection:

LAYER 1 — CONTENT ID SCANNING

Every track gets scanned against a database of known AI-generated audio patterns. Suno, Udio, and similar tools have recognizable sonic fingerprints. When a match is found — the track gets flagged automatically.

LAYER 2 — RIGHTS VERIFICATION

When you upload through a distributor, you sign a declaration that you own the rights. With a free Suno account, you don't. Suno's free tier gives personal use only — not commercial distribution rights.

⚠️ WHAT HAPPENS WHEN PLATFORMS FIND OUT

Track gets taken down (sometimes within days) · Royalties get withheld · Distributor account suspended · In some cases — permanent platform ban.

This isn't a risk worth taking. And it's completely avoidable — once you know the rules.

YOUR OPTIONS

TWO REAL PATHS FORWARD

PATH A

GET THE RIGHTS YOU NEED

Upgrade your Suno subscription to unlock commercial distribution rights. Fastest path if you're committed to AI-generated music.

QUICKEST START

PATH B

USE AI AS YOUR TOOL

Keep using AI — but as part of your creative process, not as the final creator. Human authorship makes your music fully distributable.

MOST SUSTAINABLE

PATH A — UPGRADE YOUR SUNO PLAN

PLAN	PRICE	SONGS / MONTH	COMMERCIAL RIGHTS
Free	\$0	50 credits	Personal use only ✗
Pro	\$10 / month	500 songs	Commercial use ✓
Premier	\$30 / month	Unlimited	Full commercial rights ✓

With a paid subscription — your tracks are legally distributable. **When this makes sense:** you want the fastest path to streaming with AI-generated music.

PATH B — AI AS YOUR CREATIVE TOOL

Platforms don't block AI tools. They block AI as the *sole creator* with no human authorship. The question is simple: **did a human write, perform, or meaningfully create this music?**

AI IS THE CREATOR ✗

- ✗ Prompt it, download, upload unchanged
- ✗ Only contribution is choosing outputs
- ✗ No human performance in the track
- ✗ No original composition from you

vs

AI IS YOUR TOOL ✓

- ✓ Generate chords you then play yourself
- ✓ Sketch a melody you then sing and record
- ✓ Produce a beat you layer with your vocals
- ✓ Generate reference tracks for your sound

STEP BY STEP

FROM AI IDEA TO DISTRIBUTABLE TRACK

1

GENERATE YOUR REFERENCE

Use Suno, Udio, or any AI tool to create a rough version of the sound you're going for. This is your sketch, not your final track — the same way a painter uses a pencil outline.

2

EXTRACT WHAT'S YOURS

Write down the melody. Transcribe the chord progression. Note the structure. AI helped you hear them faster — but the moment you write them down, they become yours.

3

RECORD YOURSELF

Even a basic voice memo of you singing the melody counts as human performance. You don't need a professional studio — you need your voice or instrument on the final track.

4

PRODUCE THE FINAL VERSION

Rebuild the track with your performance as the foundation. AI tools for mixing, mastering, and production are completely fine at this stage — human authorship is already established.

5**DOCUMENT EVERYTHING**

Keep your original prompts, sketches, and voice memos. If a platform questions your authorship, your creative process is your proof. A folder on your phone is enough.

BEFORE YOU SUBMIT TO ANY DISTRIBUTOR

- ☐ You wrote the melody or lyrics (even if AI helped develop them)
- ☐ A human performed on the track — vocals, instrument, or both
- ☐ You have commercial rights to any AI-generated elements used
- ☐ You can describe your creative process if asked
- ☐ The track doesn't contain samples you don't own

If you can check all five — you're ready to distribute. And you're ready to reapply to AIR.

NEXT STEPS

WHEN YOU'RE READY, WE'LL BE HERE.

We kept your application on file. The music industry is figuring out AI in real time. Artists who understand both the tools and the rules will have a serious advantage. You're already ahead of most.

- At least 1 track that meets the criteria above
- A Spotify artist profile with that release live
- A clear sense of what you're building and where you want to go

[REAPPLY TO AIR MUSIC →](#)

Chloe Harper

AIR Music Distribution

air.io

Good music takes time.
Keep building. We'll be here.